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MILITARY SPECIFICATION

HAM SLICES IN BRINE, THERMOSTABILIZED, TRAY PACK

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers ham slices in brine thermostabilized in tray pack cans for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Documents. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

TT-C-495	-	Coatings, Exterior, For Tinned Food Cans
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8905

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MILITARY

MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification For

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-900 - Bacterial Standards for Starches, Flours, Cereals, Alimentary Pastes, Dry Milks and Sugars Used in the Preparation of Thermostabilized Foods for the Armed Forces

(Copies of documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents. The following other Government documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those in effect on the date of the solicitation.

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

Institutional Meat Purchase Specifications for Fresh Pork, Series 400

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Livestock and Seed Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

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U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Market Research and Development Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

National Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Office of Drinking Water, Environmental Protection Agency, WH550D, 401 M Street, S.W., Washington, DC 20460.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS shall be the issues of the nongovernment documents which are current on the date of the solicitation.

ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF CEREAL CHEMISTS (AACC)

Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Cereal Chemists, 3340 Pilot Knob Road, St. Paul, MN 55121.)

NATIONAL ACADEMY OF SCIENCES

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

(Technical society and technical association documents are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

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2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence. Nothing in this document, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified in the contract or purchase order, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.4, 6.1, and 6.3).

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Ham. The ham shall meet the requirements for Institutional Meat Purchase Specifications (IMPS) No. 402B, except ham tying shall not be necessary, and all the shank meat shall be removed and excluded. The ham shall be of Selection No. 2 with a weight range of 8 to 14 pounds and a maximum average fat thickness of 1/4 inch.

3.2.1.1 Handling and storage. Handling and storage of the boned and trimmed ham, prior to processing into the finished product, shall be in accordance with the following requirements:

a. Ham processed on the day of initial certification shall be maintained in the temperature range of 28° to 50°F, inclusive.

b. Holding in the fresh-chilled state for not more than 4 days after initial certification is permitted, provided that the ham is maintained in the temperature range of 28° to 40°F, inclusive.

c. Holding in the frozen state for not more than 120 days after initial certification is permitted, provided that the ham is:

- Frozen to 0°F or lower within 72 hours after initial certification.
- Stored at 0°F or lower.
- Protected from freezer deterioration and damage.
- Stored in containers that are adequate to maintain product excellence.
- Held after storage at an internal temperature not to exceed 40°F when further processing is resumed.

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3.2.2 Salt. Salt shall be noniodized, white, refined, sodium chloride with or without anticaking agents and shall comply with the purity standards for sodium chloride of the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.3 Water. Water used for formulation, ice making, and washing shall conform to the National Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.2.4 Sugar, white, granulated. Sugar shall be white, refined, granulated cane or beet sugar, or a combination thereof, and shall comply with MIL-STD-900.

3.2.5 Sodium tripolyphosphate. Sodium tripolyphosphate shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.6 Sodium ascorbate. Sodium ascorbate shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.7 Sodium erythorbate. Sodium erythorbate shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.8 Sodium nitrite. Sodium nitrite shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.9 Flavoring, smoke. Smoke flavoring shall be an oil-based liquid with a density of 7.7 pounds per gallon, a stability of greater than 30 hours (A.O.M.), and a phenolic level (dimethoxyphenol) of 7.5 mg per mL (see 6.4).

3.2.10 Preblended spice and seasoning mixture. Preblended spices and seasonings may be used. The spices and seasonings in the mixture shall comply with the requirements of this document. The containers used for the spice and seasoning blend shall be labeled with each ingredient and the percentage of each ingredient in the blend. The ingredients shall be in the same proportions as specified in the ingredient formula.

3.3 Preparation and processing. Processing shall be on a continuous basis.

3.3.1 Preparation of the cured ham. The ham shall be prepared as follows:

a. Boned and trimmed ham which meets the requirements of 3.2.1 shall be further trimmed, if necessary, to assure compliance with finished product requirements (see 3.6). The frozen and certified ham shall be tempered/thawed and shall not exceed 40°F at time of further processing.

b. The boned and trimmed ham shall be reduced in size to chunk-type pieces by mechanically grinding once through a kidney-shaped plate, having openings measuring 2-1/2 inches or more in the least dimension, and using a two-bladed knife that yields pieces weighing at least 2 ounces.

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3.3.1.1 Mixing. The chunked ham pieces shall be mechanically mixed with the following cure ingredients for approximately 15 minutes or until the product becomes moderately tacky.

Ingredient	Pounds per 100 pounds of ham
Water or ice	3.0000
Salt 1/	2.5000
Sugar, white, granulated	1.0000
Sodium tripolyphosphate	0.2500
Sodium ascorbate and/or sodium erythorbate	0.0550
Flavoring, smoke	0.0400
Sodium nitrite 2/	0.0156

1/ The total amount of salt in the formula shall be adjusted, as necessary, to produce a product that complies with the finished product salt requirements (see 3.6).

2/ Sodium nitrite shall be of sufficient strength to assure a complete cure without exceeding 156 parts per million of nitrite in the cured ham during preparation.

The mixture shall be held prior to or after the stuffing operation in the temperature range of 38° to 42°F for not less than 12 hours nor more than 72 hours before cooking, to assure uniform cure dispersion in the mixture.

3.3.1.2 Stuffing and forming. The cured ham mixture shall be mechanically stuffed tightly into number 7 regenerated cellulose prestuck casings. The resultant meat logs (rolls) shall be mechanically formed to comply with a cross-sectioned shape and dimension approximating figure 1. The open ends shall be sealed to exert minimum pressure on the meat.

3.3.1.3 Cooking. The formed ham logs shall be cooked by one of the following methods to provide a product meeting the finished product requirements.

a. Cook house method. The meat logs shall be cooked in a cook house (smokehouse without smoke) at a temperature range of 160° to 162°F and 100 percent relative humidity until the internal product temperature reaches 150° to 152°F.

b. Water cooking method. The meat logs shall be cooked in water until the internal product temperature reaches 150° to 152°F.

3.3.1.4 Cooling and storage. The cooked ham logs shall be cooled to 40°F or below within 24 hours following the cooking process. The cooled, cooked ham logs shall be held not longer than 48 hours at a temperature not to exceed 40°F after removal from the cooking process and prior to slicing. Alternatively, if the cooked ham logs are to be held longer than 48 hours after cooking, they shall be mechanically stuffed and vacuum-sealed in heat-sealable casing

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materials made from FDA and USDA food approved laminate consisting of 0.0005 inch thick polyester and 0.0015 inch thick medium density polyethylene. The cooled, cooked ham logs shall be maintained in the temperature range of 28° to 40°F for a period of not more than 30 days from the date of pack until slicing. All ham shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a USDA, Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS) Livestock and Seed Division certificate to certify compliance with the cooling and storage requirements.

3.3.1.5 Slicing. The ham logs shall be sliced to a uniform size, shape, and 1/2 inch thickness. The time from slicing to filling shall be continuous. The ham slices shall be filled into the tray pack cans within 4 hours after being sliced. End slices shall not be used.

3.3.1.6 Alternate processing for cured ham. Cured hams processed by methods other than the chunking method described in 3.3.1b, as sectioned and formed, or massaging of intact ham muscle, etc., will be acceptable. If using an alternate processing method, the preparation and processing techniques of this document, except for chunking, shall be required.

3.3.2 Brine preparation.

a. Salt shall be completely dissolved in water to provide a 0.5 to 1.0 percent brine strength. (At the time of filling salt tablets may be substituted for granular salt in brine preparation.)

b. Brine shall be made fresh daily, and brine remaining at the end of a production day shall be discarded.

3.4 Tray pack filling and sealing. Each tray pack can (see 5.1.1) shall be filled with product to conform to the finished product requirements and to the following requirements:

a. Not less than 36 ham slices shall be packed shingled in two rows, lengthwise, in the tray pack can.

b. The product at the time of filling shall be in the temperature range of 28° to 40°F.

c. The tray pack can shall be filled with brine to a total can content weight of 106 ounces. Brine may be filled hot or cold.

d. Each can shall be hermetically sealed under a vacuum established by a processing authority and specified in the scheduled process so as to assure compliance with the finished product requirement (see 3.6s).

e. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in the retort process within 2 hours after sealing.

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3.5 Tray pack thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be thermostabilized by retorting until a sterilization value (F_o) of not less than 6 has been achieved.

3.6 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, or metal.

b. There shall be no foreign odor or flavor such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, or moldy.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

d. The texture of the slices shall not be dry, rubbery, or mushy.

e. No individual can shall contain less than 36 intact ham slices.

f. Ham slices shall approximate the size and shape shown in figure 1.

g. The average total can content weight shall be not less than 106 ounces.

h. No individual can shall have a total can content weight of less than 104 ounces.

i. Drained weight of 36 intact ham slices in any individual tray pack can shall be not less than 56.0 ounces.

j. The average fat content of the finished product shall not be greater than 12.0 percent and no individual tray pack shall have a fat content greater than 14.0 percent.

k. The salt content of the finished product shall be not less than 1.5 percent nor greater than 2.0 percent.

l. No individual can shall have a ham slice with adherent fat or a fat pocket measuring more than 1/2 inch by 1/2 inch.

m. The product shall show no evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched).

n. Total weight of cartilage, coarse connective tissue, section of tendons or ligaments, and glandular material, collectively, in any individual can shall be not more than 2.0 ounces.

o. No individual can shall contain a bone piece measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension.

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p. The average drained weight of the ham slices shall be not less than 60.0 ounces.

q. No individual can shall contain a ham slice with a void area or air pocket measuring 1/2 inch or more in any dimension.

r. The ham slice shall not contain finely ground, flaked, or otherwise comminuted product.

s. Filled, sealed, and retorted cans shall show evidence of proper vacuum as determined by concavity of the can lid (see 4.5.6).

3.6.1 Palatability. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.7 Plant qualification. The meat component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture.

3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this document. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of inspection necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this document.

4.3 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this document and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this document or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

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4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

4.5.1.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, or compliance be verified by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. If necessary, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically or inspected according to generally recognized test methods such as the standard methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists and in the Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists, to determine conformance to the requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, can interior coating, filling, sealing, and packing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation, or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.5.3 Tray pack inspection. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in one workshift. The USDA reserves the right to separate the inspection lot into smaller inspection lots.

4.5.3.1 Total can content weight inspection. Randomly select 30 filled and sealed tray pack cans from the inspection lot and weigh separately. Subtract the average tare weight (determined by randomly selecting and weighing 30 of the empty tray pack cans and lids used in preparing the product and dividing the total weight by 30) from the weight of each tray pack in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 1 ounce. If the average total can content weight is less than 106 ounces or if the total can content weight of any individual can is less than 104 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

4.5.3.2 Product inspection. The sample size shall be as indicated by the double sampling plan specified in table I. The tray pack cans shall be selected at random from the lot. The tray pack cans shall be heated for 15 minutes in boiling water, opened, and inspected for defects listed in table II.

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TABLE I. Double sampling plan for product inspection 1/

Lot size (cans)	Sample size (cans)	Cumulative sample	Acceptance number	Rejection number
0 to 3,200	8	--	0	2
	8	16	1	2
3,201 to 35,000	13	--	0	3
	13	26	3	4

1/ a. If no defects are found in the first sample, the lot shall be accepted.

b. If the number of defects found in the first sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If the number of defects found in the first sample exceeds the acceptance number but is less than the rejection number, the second sample shall be inspected. Defects found in the first and second samples shall be combined and if the number of defects in the cumulative sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

TABLE II. Product defects 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Drained weight of 36 intact ham slices in any individual tray pack can is less than 56.0 ounces. 3/ 4/
102	Texture of ham slice is dry, rubbery, or mushy.
103	Less than 36 intact ham slices in any individual can.
104	Slices not approximating the size and shape shown in figure 1.
105	Total weight of cartilage, coarse connective tissue, section of tendons or ligaments, and glandular material, collectively, in a can is more than 2.0 ounces.
106	Product shows evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched).

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TABLE II. Product defects 1/ 2/ (cont'd)

Category	Defect
Major	
107	Slices not arranged in a shingled manner.
108	Ham slice has adherent fat or a fat pocket measuring more than 1/2 inch by 1/2 inch.
109	Presence of a bone piece measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension.
110	Ham slice contains finely ground, flaked, or otherwise comminuted product.
111	Presence of void area or air pocket measuring 1/2 inch or more in any dimension.

1/ The presence of foreign material (e.g. dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, metal), foreign odor or flavor (e.g. burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary by an AMS agent.)

3/ To determine drained weight, the free liquid in the can shall be poured off and the remaining contents shall be poured into a flat-bottom container. A minimum of three times the tray pack can's volume of 190° to 212°F water shall be added to the container so as to cover the contents. The contents and water shall be agitated so as to liquify rendered fat without breaking the ham slices. The contents shall then be poured into a U.S. Standard 1/2 inch sieve in a manner that will distribute the product over the sieve without breaking the ham slices. Sieve area shall be such that the distributed product does not completely cover all the openings of the sieve. The sieve shall be tilted at approximately a 45° angle and allowed to drain for 2 minutes before determining the drained weight. Thirty-six intact ham slices shall be weighed to determine the drained weight. The drained weight shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce.

4/ The lot shall be rejected if the sample average drained weight is less than 60.0 ounces.

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4.5.3.3 Fat and salt content testing. Nine tray pack cans shall be selected at random from the lot and distributed as follows:

- Three for laboratory analyses.
- Three for submission to the contractor.
- Three for retention by an AMS agent as reserve samples.

The three tray packs for laboratory analyses shall be individually tested for fat and salt content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, chapter: Meat and Meat Products, except that preparation of the samples shall be as follows: The three unopened tray packs shall be gently warmed in a water bath to melt fat adhering to the inside of the cans. The cans shall be opened and the brine solution drained. The remaining drained contents of each can shall be separately blended in a Waring blender or equivalent. The test results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. The lot shall be rejected if:

a. The average fat content of the three tray packs is greater than 12.0 percent.

b. The fat content of any individual tray pack is greater than 14.0 percent.

c. The salt content of any individual tray pack is less than 1.5 percent or greater than 2.0 percent.

Analysis of reserve samples at the request of the contractor shall not be permitted unless the original laboratory analysis indicated that the involved lot will be rejected because of noncompliance with the fat or salt content requirement. When the reserve samples are analyzed, the analyses for both fat and salt shall be made and will be considered final. Unused reserve samples shall be returned to the contractor for inclusion in subsequent lots.

4.5.4 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers, except that the inspection for labeling shall be in accordance with MIL-L-1497 (see 5.4).

4.5.5. Can closure examination. Can closure shall be examined visually and by teardowns in accordance with the can manufacturer's requirement and CFR 21, Part 113, Subpart D, or CFR 9, Part 318, Subpart G, as applicable. Any nonconformance based on observation of can seam teardowns or of record of can seam teardowns shall be cause for rejection of any involved product.

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4.5.6 Vacuum examination. Cans shall be allowed to cool to 75° ± 5°F, held for at least 24 hours after sealing, and then examined for vacuum retention. To examine, lay a straight edge in the center of the lid along the length of the tray pack. Both ends of the straight edge shall touch the lid at the inside edge of the double seam. There shall be a visible gap between the straight edge and the lid for the entire distance of the label panel. Using a shorter straight edge, the same procedure shall be used across the width, in the center of the tray pack can. When examining a ribbed lid, only lay the straight edge between the two center ribs along the length of the can. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in a single shift on a single sealing machine. The sample size shall be 50 cans. Any nonconforming tray pack can shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.7 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure, and reinforcement (when applicable) in accordance with PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows:

Major: National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible;
Reinforced with other than nonmetallic strapping or tape;
Dimensions of pads not as specified;
Interior packing with fiberboard liner or pads not as specified.

Minor: Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible;
Arrangement or number of cans not as specified.

4.5.8 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. The product shall be preserved in accordance with level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. A size 1001 by 1206 by 200 tray pack can shall be filled, sealed, and thermoprocessed as specified in 3.4 and 3.5. The base plate of the can shall be electrolytic chromium-coated steel and shall be of sufficient temper to protect the product during shipment and storage. The base plate weight of the body and end of each can shall be 90 pounds per base box. The entire inside area of the can shall be coated. Scratches or fractures shall not penetrate through the interior can coating. The interior can coating shall not peel or blister when in contact with the product. The interior can coating shall neither affect nor be affected by the packaged product. A certificate of conformance shall be furnished to certify compliance with the interior can coating requirements. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to type I of TT-C-495.

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5.1.1.1 When specified (see 6.1), the base plate of the can shall be electrolytic chromium-coated steel and shall be of sufficient temper to protect the product during shipment and storage. The base plate weight of the body and end of each can shall be 98 pounds per base box. The body design shall be reinforced on the bottom with six longitudinal beads or ribs 0.050 ± 0.010 inches deep. The beads shall be 9 inches by 3/4 inch in length and width and shall be equidistant in the center panel of the bottom. The end design shall be reinforced with eight longitudinal beads 0.018 ± 0.004 inches deep. The beads shall be 11 inches by 3/4 inch in length and width and shall be equidistant in the center panel of the end. The center four beads on the end design shall be interrupted to provide a 5-inch by 5-inch flat center panel for labeling. The apex of all these beads shall be outward. The interior and exterior can coating requirements shall be as specified in 5.1.1.

5.1.2 Level C. The product shall be preserved as specified in 5.1.1, except that cans with commercial exterior coating will be acceptable.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level A, B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L or HSC-L with a HSC full depth cover, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box, with the first two cans placed with the lids together and the next two cans with the lids together. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads fabricated of grade V3c fiberboard. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box. Each box shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.1) except that the unit load shall consist of 48 boxes with 12 boxes per course and four courses per load with all courses having the same pattern so as to create columnar stacking. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1, except the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard.

5.2.3 Level C packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box, with the first two cans placed with the lids together and the next two cans with the lids together. The

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inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box and shall be fabricated of the same material as the box.

5.3 Unit loading. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2.2 and 5.2.3, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified except that the unit load shall consist of 48 boxes with 12 boxes per course and four courses per load with all courses having the same pattern so as to create columnar stacking. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.4 Labeling. Each tray pack can shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497 and with the following:

- Official establishment number (e.g., est 38) or a three letter code identifying the establishment.
- Lot number 1/
- Production shift number 1/
- Retort identification number 1/
- Retort cook number 1/

1/ The lot number shall be expressed as a four digit Julian code. The first digit shall indicate the year of production and the next three digits shall indicate the day of the year (Example, March 19, 1987 would be coded as 7078). The Julian code shall represent the day the product was packaged and processed. Sub-lotting (when used) shall be represented by an alpha character immediately following the four digit Julian code. Following the four digit Julian code and the alpha character (when used), the other required code information shall be printed in the sequence as listed above.

In addition, the name of the product shall be marked, stamping is permitted, on one 1001 by 200 side of the can. The labeling shall be legible when examined as specified in 4.5.4 after preparation of product in accordance with heating instructions. Paper labels are not permitted. Cans shall show the following statements:

TO HEAT

a. To heat in water: Submerge sealed can in boiling water. Bring to a boil, continue boiling for 40 to 45 minutes. Avoid overheating to the point where internal pressure is evident (can shows evidence of bulging). Remove from water and open lid for serving.

CAUTION: Use care when opening as pressure may have been generated within the can.

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b. To heat in oven: Either punch several holes in lid of tray can or open can in usual manner leaving the loose lid in place to prevent moisture loss. Place in a 350°F oven for approximately 35 to 40 minutes until contents reach an internal temperature of 165°F.

WARNING: Do not place closed can in oven, as heating will increase internal pressure which may cause the can to burst.

YIELD: Serves 18 portions of 2 slices each.

5.5 Marking.

5.5.1 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.5.2 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078. In addition, when tray pack cans are fabricated from 90 pounds per base box, the following precautionary marking in capital letters larger than other markings shall be included:

CAUTION: DO NOT STACK PALLETS IN TRANSIT OR MORE THAN TWO HIGH IN STORAGE

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4, and 6.3).
c. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1 and 6.3).
d. Level of preservation and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
e. When tray pack cans are to be fabricated from 98 pounds per base box (see 5.1.1.1).
f. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.2.1 and 5.3).

6.2 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specific item being procured, the procuring activity should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

6.3 First article. When a first article sample is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

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6.4 Flavoring, smoke. It has been found that Red Arrow CharOil (single strength) manufactured by Red Arrow Products Company, P.O. Box 3037, Maintowoc, WI, 54220 meets the requirements of 3.2.9 and performs satisfactorily in this product.

6.5 Subject term (key word) listing.

Canned food
Food Processing
Ham
Ration
Thermostabilized
Tray pack

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8905-B051

Review activities:

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC
DP - SS

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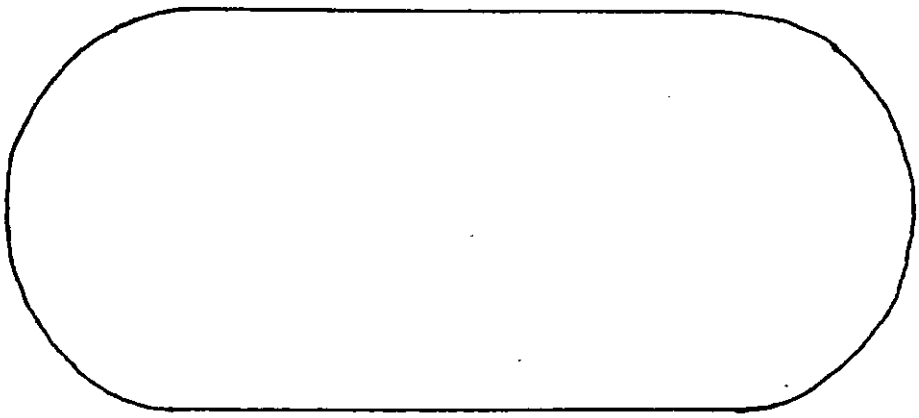


Figure 1

HAM SLICE SHAPE

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-H-44298	Ham Slices in Brine, Thermostabilized, Tray Pack

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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